FIRST-TIME MUTUAL FUND SIP INVESTOR INTERVIEWS (N = 8)

> *Written up from the researcher's interview notes with help from an AI assistant, then checked by the researcher. Answers are lightly edited, not word-for-word recordings. Names are replaced with P-ids.*

Participant 01: P01 (28M, Sales Manager)

> **Participant Profile:** 28M · Sales Manager
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> **Investment Timeline:** First successful instalment in July 2024; salary-funded; ended 11 months later during a job switch, never started again

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P01: Had just started my first job after MBA, was already 26, so I knew I was late to starting my earning and saving journey. So started the SIP straight after my first salary

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P01 : As I said, I started myself because I knew the importance of investing coming from a middle class family. FD's seemed too boring, that's what my parents had been doing for 35 odd years now. I wanted to take risks, research and advice from elder sister ended me up into the world of MF and SIP

Q3. Why Groww?

P01 : I had already set Groww up as I started investing in some stocks and IPO's. It is the most popular platform anyways. Though my continued research and interest into the topic made me think Zerodha was the better option. It is what it is.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P01 : My research told me this was going to be a long term thing, I was in it for the long haul. I also knew that is the only way MF's will 100% return money. The short life span wasn't meant for SIP's in MF's. That is what my research through youtube, finance advisors and AI told me.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P01: 20% of the salary as the magic number. That is what I came up to after deep research. I promised myself that amount would go up with every appraisal and job switch

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P01: Research here too. It was ofcourse supposed to be after my salary date. I read somewhere that mid month investments are best for long term gains, sounds baseless and stupid in hindsight. But yeah, mid month, so I picked the 13th, my birth date.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P01: While I had the job, it came from my salary. Things didn't work out. I ended up jobless for 6 months, so discontinued the SIP. But yeah, it came from my salary

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

Not asked — participant's first SIP is not an ELSS tax-saver fund.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P01: Intial few months heavy interest, checking 3-5 times a week. Dopamine hit if green. Looking at the money increasing month on month, not just in returns, but total investments from my side, was good for me. Kept me sane knowing I was securing my future. As the job stuff got tougher, the checking reduced, once a month maybe. To now almost never.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P01 : The mandate was set up, first installment I paid when setting up the SIP itself. Mandate for the next month onwards.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight

Normally the way any autopay is set up. Process was smooth

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

Once the money gets deducted from bank, it still takes 3-4 business days to reflect in the SIP account or MF account. I did not know tha initially, it caused some panic. Once I got to know that, I was chill. The app showed the order status anyway

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

Answered that just last question. It takes some time, but it is safe. We can check the status in app

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

I don’t think so, normal process. Although the process is a bit long and in depth to create those demat accounts, I did not know that at the time

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

I was pretty locked onto it as long as it ran, so no, I don’t think it was going to fail.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

I ended the SIP way back, so this does not apply to me.I ended when I didn’t know where the next salary was coming from. Paid 1-2 months from my savings, but that was dry quick. Ended the SIP in month 11. Kept the money in there as I intended to restart after finding a new job.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

Not restarted yet, even though I have had the new job. Responsbilities changed, I need to pay rent now, was not the case before. I plan to restart when I do have some monthly disposable income.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

The colour of my portfolio, percentage increase, and absolute money increase.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

It was flat pretty much. As I said, I checked it multiple times a week, there was no major change at all.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

Been 2-3 months since I opened, thing is, I am busy. And I don't have the income to start again right now, so it is a side thought for now

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

I paused in month 11. yes. It has been almost 17 months later now, and I have not restarted. Reasons are simple – no job for a while, which was followed by paying Mumbai rent when I got the job.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

I stopped it myself ofc, for reasons mentioned above. Actually, paused, not stopped.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

I knew cancelling was an option, I don't even know if I can restart it now after 17 months of pausing.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

Not the combined number. But some of the funds were, yes. All I considered and researched for was pausing or cancelling SIP in those funds and moving it elsewhere. But I wanted to give it some time, as it came from my own deep research, they were my choices, made with depth of thought.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

I don't remember a time like that, but my likely resort is Youtube finfluencers, and more recently, Claude pro.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

No. never needed to

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Scenario Card : Your bank shows the SIP money has gone. Two days later Groww still shows processing and no new units.

Interviewer: *What would you do next? Where would you look first, who would you ask, and what would you do with the SIP?*

I will check the order status, if it is processing, I will give it couple more days. These things fall in place with time eventually. But just to be sure, I will raise a complaint on Grooww customer support in app and via mail.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

I think if I had not gone through that period without a job, I would not have discontinued even after having to pay rent. Because it is paused right now, I am in a comfort zone and delaying the restart, which is not great for my long term plans, I need to get this sorted asap.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

In my case, it is not the SIP, not the app, not the MFs. Purely personal reasons, that said, more green on the returns and a better market state would prompt me to restart quicker. I am taking my time because the market is do down.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

I think you could have asked about large cap, small cap, mid cap etc preferences, basically type of funds they are interested in. Would help profile people better. Safe or risky investors, I am sure that somehow would connect to the SIP behaviour

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

Text me, I will be happy to help out

Participant 02: P02 (25M, Data Analyst)

> **Participant Profile:** 25M · Data Analyst.
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> **Investment Timeline:** First successful instalment on 6 May 2026; salary-funded; continues at the original contribution amount. Latest completed instalment on 6 October; next scheduled date on 6 November. No payment failures or delays.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P02: My first appraisal had just happened. Until then I kept saying I would start once my salary improved. When it did, I realised I could just let the extra money disappear into spending again. So I made a quick decision and set it up in April for the following month. I wanted to do one sensible thing with the increased cash before I started and got used to increasing my spend instead.

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P02: A colleague who joined with me had been telling me to start something monthly, he was already a SIP investor. After the appraisal he asked whether I'd actually done it. He showed me his contribution history, not just the final balance. Then I asked couple of more people from my team, everyone had SIP’s going on, atleast in small amounts. So I remember thinking, okay, this is something people around me actually

maintain. I also watched a couple of beginner videos that evening. I didn't understand everything in them. But I know I want to be responsible with my money and compound it long term as they say.

Q3. Why Groww?

P02: My colleague used Groww, so I could ask him where things were. I downloaded it and could follow the setup without calling anyone. I didn't compare every app. The familiarity mattered more than any particular feature. I also considered Zerodha, but Groww was always the frontrunner.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P02: I expected it to be a long-term thing, but I also expected to see some encouraging progress in six months. Those two ideas were both there. The fund page had historical returns and I carried that number into my head. I wasn't literally expecting the whole year's return immediately, but I thought the monthly direction would look a bit steadier. We are in a market fall stage in India right now, so this is expected

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P02: The amount of the appraisal, simple as that. I wanted to start somewhere. That was the priority

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P02: The sixth. Salary normally comes at the end of the previous month, and I wanted a few days in between. It wasn't based on which day the market might be cheaper. I wanted the money to go before I started spending the new month's salary.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P02: My own salary, from the same account since the start. There hasn't been a month when paying this particular SIP meant borrowing or missing a bill.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

Not asked — participant's first SIP is not an ELSS tax-saver fund.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P02: May was mostly checking whether I'd done the setup correctly. I would open it multiple times a week just to look and feel good. June I started watching the total value. In July it wasn't looking the way I had imagined and I compared it with the chart on the fund page. August was when I asked my colleague about that. September was busy at work and I checked less. October went out as usual. I remember those phases; I couldn't honestly tell you what happened to the value in every individual month.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P02: On 6 May. The bank message came first. Later I saw the investment reflected and thought, fine, it's started. I didn't count the day I pressed the setup button as the first payment. It happened on the date I'd selected. The MF thing takes 3-4 days to reflect in the account.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight

I haven't changed the bank or the instruction since. I checked it once before the first date because I wasn't sure whether creating the SIP and allowing the debit were the same thing.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P02: Nothing I can point to as a failed instalment. I checked the first one quite closely and the later ones have matched what I expected. I've never had to fix a payment or pay a charge that I know of.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P02: I've seen the bank message before opening Groww, but I haven't had a two-day wait or missing-money problem. I wouldn't say I know the normal processing time. It just hasn't become a problem for me.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P02: No issue that held me up. There were verification steps and then I could proceed. I don't remember the exact sequence now.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P02: September, yes. I was working late for a couple of weeks. The bank message would probably be how I'd notice, except I also dismiss a lot of those messages. If nothing came at all, I might not immediately notice. I don't have a separate monthly reminder to verify it.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

P02: I'd go into mutual funds and then the SIP section. My first instinct is to look at the fund and see that the SIP is there. But that only tells me I've set one up, doesn't it? I'd open the transactions next. For November it's still before my date, so there shouldn't be a November success yet. I'd use the October entry and compare it with the bank debit. I couldn't promise the exact label without looking at the real screen.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P02: The sixth of November. I'd check it in the SIP details, rather than work it out from the last debit. The date itself is familiar now; I don't normally open the app just to check it.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P02: The total value, then the return. If it's red, I still have that small reaction of, why am I doing this? I know that's a bit dramatic for a small movement. In July I thought the return on the fund page and my own return were measuring the same thing. I hadn't really considered that my money was going in on different dates.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P02: A few days after the May payment, I looked at the value and it was almost the same as what had gone in. Mostly I was relieved that I could see the investment. I thought, okay, now it should start growing. I wasn't expecting much after a few days, but I had pictured a fairly steady move upward after that. The comparison with the fund chart came later, in July.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P02: At the start, almost daily. Now maybe once or twice a week, sometimes less. Last time was over the weekend after someone at work mentioned their portfolio. I opened mine, looked at it, and closed it. I didn't do anything to the SIP.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P02: In July I considered stopping this one and trying something else. The contribution was affordable; I was questioning the choice. I searched a few beginner questions and sent my colleague the wording of what confused me, without sharing the balance. He asked what period I was comparing. I didn't get completely confident that evening, but I decided not to change it just because I was annoyed with the number.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

Not asked — participant has not stopped or lapsed.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P02: I knew I could cancel. I had heard about changing the amount, but I hadn't looked closely because I didn't need to.

Interviewer follow-up: *Before this conversation, had you heard of skipping one month or lowering the amount?*

P02: Lowering, yes. Skipping, I'm not sure. I'd want to check what happens the following month rather than assume it starts again by itself.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P02: Yes, it looked almost flat around July. I thought flat meant I had picked badly, even though I'd only been doing it a few months. What stopped me acting was realising that I couldn't explain the comparison I was making. Also, nothing had changed about why I put the money aside. That doesn't mean I enjoy seeing red now. I thought about replacing it, but let the following payment go ahead.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P02: The last time was about my return versus the fund's displayed history. I went to my colleague first and then searched for an explanation of SIP returns. One article made more sense than the video I had watched. I left the contribution alone. I didn't contact support because I didn't think a payment had gone wrong. I did ask ChatGPT for help too

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P02: No. I wouldn't know whether support would answer a question about returns or just direct me to something to read. For a missing payment I would try them; for whether I'm interpreting the investment sensibly, I tend to ask someone I know.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Scenario Card 2: Your bank shows the SIP money has gone. Two days later Groww still shows processing and no new units.

Interviewer: *What would you do next? Where would you look first, who would you ask, and what would you do with the SIP?*

P02: I'd look at that particular transaction first and then check the bank debit. If it's still processing, I'd look for how long I'm meant to wait and how to contact support about that entry. I'd probably ask my colleague if he'd seen it. I wouldn't pay again straight away because I wouldn't know if that would create a second purchase. I don't think I'd cancel all future payments that day, but I'd want an answer before the next one.

Note: Prospective response to a hypothetical scenario card, rather than a past payment incident.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P02: It's a manageable commitment and it happens without me having to approve it each time. The appraisal was the push to start, but that feeling isn't there every month. Mostly I haven't found a reason strong enough to change it. Having someone I can ask a basic question helps too.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P02: In July I wanted to understand what the two return figures actually referred to. I didn't need someone saying it would definitely be fine. If I could work out why the numbers differed, I'd be less likely to keep opening different pages and making myself more confused.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P02: I can be consistent with the payment and still not understand the investment very well. I think people assume those come together once you've started.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P02: I could probably look at something after work, depending on the day. I'd rather try it myself first than have someone explain every step.

Participant 03: P03 (26F, Customer Success Manager)

> **Participant Profile:** 26F · Customer Success Manager.
> **Investment Timeline:** Started first job in January 2026; first successful instalment on 5 February. Salary-funded and continuing. Latest completed instalment on 5 October; next scheduled date on 5 November.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P03: I'd got my first job and finally had money coming in that was mine to manage. For the first month I was mostly paying for things I needed and getting used to the salary. Then I felt I should put something aside regularly. I set up the SIP in January and the first monthly payment was in February. Before the job, a regular commitment didn't feel practical.

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P03: A friend from college had started before me. She said to choose something I could keep paying even in an expensive month. I also saw plenty of posts about starting with your first salary. They made it feel like a normal next step, although none of those posts told me much about how the first few months might actually look.

Q3. Why Groww?

P03: My friend could explain how she used it, and the setup looked manageable. I was also reluctant to ask someone at home to do the whole thing for me. I wanted to understand enough to handle it myself.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P03: I thought the balance would gradually be higher than what I'd paid in. I knew there could be ups and downs, but I pictured that as something happening later, after it had built up a little. I didn't have an exact target. I wanted to see that I'd started saving properly within the year.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P03: After rent, sending money home and the regular bills, I picked a contribution that left some breathing room. I wanted to start low and build it over time

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P03: The fifth. Salary usually comes at the end of the month. I wanted rent to be sorted first and then the SIP. I didn't know there was any reason to optimise the date beyond having money in the account.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P03: Salary. It's been the same source throughout. Some months have more spending, but this SIP hasn't been stopped because I couldn't cover it.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

Not asked — participant's first SIP is not an ELSS tax-saver fund.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P03: February I was pleased just to see it begin. In March I saw the value below what I'd put in and asked my friend if I had selected something wrong. April and May became fairly routine. June was the awkward payment month: the bank had debited but I couldn't see the new investment yet. After it appeared, July through October were normal payments. I stopped opening the app as often, though I still check after the debit now.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P03: 5 February. I saw the bank message, then later the transaction in Groww. I remember checking with my friend that the first payment was different from just setting up the instruction. It went out when I expected.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight away? Have you changed it?

P03: I approved the recurring payment while setting it up. There was a pending step before it was ready, but I don't remember it taking more than that day. I haven't changed the account or approval since. I haven't gone back into the bank app to inspect the permission every month.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P03: June looked confusing. I had the debit message, but the app still looked as if the purchase was in progress. I think the wording was processing; I wouldn't swear to it. I checked again the following day, then used help from inside the app. I got a response about processing, but I was still checking for the actual entry. It appeared after roughly a couple of working days. I can't say the support response caused that to happen. I didn't see a separate charge, although I didn't audit the whole statement for fees. That’s when I realized it takes 2-3 business days to reflect in my account.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P03: That's the June incident I just mentioned, not another one. The strange part was seeing the money leave and not being able to point to where it had gone inside Groww. I took the bank debit as evidence that I'd done my part. After it settled I trusted it again, but I now look at the specific payment after a debit, not only the total balance.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P03: One verification step stayed pending overnight when I first signed up. I checked again the next day and could continue. I didn't have to change my details or contact anyone about it. I wouldn't connect that to the later June delay.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P03: August, probably. Work got busy and I wasn't opening it much. I still saw the bank messages. If a debit failed, I hope the message would tell me, but I can't be certain I would read it immediately. The June experience made me a bit more deliberate about checking later.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

Verbal app walkthrough (privacy protocol — screen and rupee amounts not shared).

P03: I'd open mutual funds, find the SIP and then look for the individual payment or transaction history. Just looking at the overall balance wouldn't answer it. November hasn't happened yet because my date is the fifth. The latest completed one is October. I'd want the completed entry for that month and the bank debit to agree. I sometimes hesitate between the fund's general page and my own investment page.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P03: 5 November. I'd find it in the SIP details. I know the day, but if I were changing anything I would check what date the app actually lists instead of assuming my change applies immediately.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P03: Usually the total return. Red feels like I've already made a mistake, even when the money is meant to stay for years. In March I thought maybe the SIP itself was somehow deducting money. I understood the idea of a market-linked investment; recognising what was happening in my own account was different.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P03: In February, after the first payment, I saw the investment entry and a value close to what I'd put in. I took that as confirmation that it had worked. I didn't spend much time understanding the return calculation then. I expected to see a small gain after another couple of payments. March was the first time the red number really caught my attention, and that was more unsettling than I'd expected.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P03: Quite often in the first two months. Now around the payment date and occasionally when somebody brings up investments. The last time was to check the October payment. I didn't spend much time comparing funds then.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P03: I thought about stopping after seeing red in March. I hadn't lost my job or needed the contribution for something else. I was wondering whether I should have waited until I understood it better. My friend asked what I had expected to happen that quickly. I read some more and let the next payment go ahead. June made me nervous for a different reason. I wanted to locate the money, not change the investment because of its return.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

Not asked — participant has not stopped or lapsed.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P03: I knew I could stop future payments. I thought pausing meant I could come back when I wanted, but I hadn't checked the actual steps.

Interviewer follow-up: *Had you heard about skipping a month or lowering the amount?*

P03: Lowering, yes. Skipping I have heard of, but I haven't used it. Before doing either I'd want to see what happens next month, because I wouldn't want to cancel something and think it was only for one month.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P03: Yes, I first noticed red in March. At first red meant I'd chosen badly or misunderstood what I was buying. I stayed because the contribution was still comfortable and I didn't have a better reason to stop than being uncomfortable with that screen. I'm not saying I felt fully confident. I just decided I didn't need to make the decision that evening. I spoke to my friend and read more before letting the next payment go ahead.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P03: For the June issue, first my friend and then Groww help, followed by AI ofcourse. She said she had seen a delay before but couldn't confirm what was happening with mine. That was when I looked for help about the actual transaction. For the March return question, I watched an explanation after speaking with her. Those were different kinds of questions. AI told me it takes 2-3 business days.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P03: Yes, the June payment. I went through the in-app help route and got a response about processing. The investment eventually appeared. I felt relieved, but the answer hadn't given me a very clear point at which I should come back if it still wasn't there. I don't know whether anyone manually changed anything.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Not administered — participant already detailed an actual payment-visibility incident in Q12–Q13.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P03: The amount fits my monthly routine. I also like seeing the contribution history because it's something I have managed to keep doing since getting the job. That feeling matters even in a month when the return isn't encouraging. I don't want to be deciding from scratch every month.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P03: With the June payment, knowing where it was and when I should take another step. Even a clear explanation that matched my particular transaction would have helped. With the red return, I needed a different explanation. A payment message wouldn't have answered that.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P03: When I ask someone a basic question, I don't necessarily want them to choose an investment for me. Sometimes I just want to check that I haven't misunderstood what the app is showing.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P03: Yes, I could try something in the evening. I'd prefer not to open my actual account for that unless I knew exactly what you needed me to do.

Participant 04: P04 (26M, IT Engineer)

> **Participant Profile:** 26M · IT Engineer.
>
> **Investment Timeline:** First successful instalment in November 2025; salary-funded with last completed debit on 10 August. September and October instalments failed following a salary bank account change during an August job switch. Next displayed schedule is 10 November; mandate update remains pending.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P04: I had some savings sitting in the account, but no regular investing habit. Around October 2025, I reviewed what I'd spent over the previous few months and realised I kept leaving this for later. I set up the SIP so I wouldn't need to remember to make a separate investment each month. Nov was the first debit.

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P04: A friend had been doing it for a while. He didn't show me a big profit figure; he said that if I kept waiting to understand everything, I might never start. I watched a beginner video after that. It made the setup seem quite straightforward. I didn't really think through what I'd need to keep checking afterwards. My family was also pushing me to have fixed monthly investment somewhere.

Q3. Why Groww?

P04: The friend used Groww and I had heard of it from other people. I was comfortable trying it without a long comparison. I didn't choose it because I knew its payment setup was better than another app's.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P04: I expected the contribution to go out every month and the investment to grow over time. I did expect a positive number fairly soon. I hadn't fixed a deadline for using the money. I think I confused starting a sensible habit with seeing a reassuring result almost immediately.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P04: A contribution I could manage after my fixed expenses. I left my emergency savings separate. It wasn't dependent on a bonus or on money someone else sent me.

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P04: The tenth, after salary. At the time it was the same bank account, so I didn't think about transferring money anywhere else. The date wasn't the problem at the beginning.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P04: Salary throughout. I changed jobs in August, and the new salary started coming to another bank account in September. The money was still available overall. I had not connected that change to the account the SIP was allowed to debit.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

Not asked — participant's first SIP is not an ELSS tax-saver fund.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P04: Nov I checked the first debit. Dec was routine. June I checked returns more often and had a moment of wondering if I should stop. July and August went through. September was the first month after the salary-account change. I saw a payment-related message but was busy joining the new team and didn't follow it up properly. October I assumed the SIP was continuing because it was still listed. Looking back at the entries here, August is the last success and the next two weren't successful. I hadn't pieced that together from the portfolio value.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P04: 10 Nov 2025. Bank message first, then the investment entry. It was on the scheduled date and there wasn't a problem with that first payment.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight away? Have you changed it?

P04: I approved automatic payments from the old salary account. It was ready before the first instalment. After changing jobs I updated some payment apps, but I didn't go back through Groww's funding account. I thought having my new account available for other payments was enough. I hadn't checked which permission this SIP still used.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P04: September didn't go through. I remember a message about a failed payment, but I don't remember the exact wording or whether it came from Groww or the payment side. I dismissed it to deal with later. The old account didn't have the money in it that I expected the new salary to cover. October also has no successful entry. I haven't completed a fix yet, so I can't give you a recovery time or say the cause is confirmed by support. I haven't checked whether the bank charged anything.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P04: Not for those missed months. I don't have a bank debit to point to for September or October. Earlier there may have been a normal gap before I saw the investment, but I don't remember a missing-money episode. This is money that didn't leave the expected account, as far as I have checked.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P04: No initial KYC issue that I remember. The early payments worked. I wouldn't describe the later account change as a problem with the original verification.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P04: September. I was thinking about the new job, not the SIP. I used to rely on the bank messages. When there wasn't a normal debit message, there wasn't much to catch my attention. I did get something about failure, but seeing it and acting on it are two different things.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

P04: I'd normally open the portfolio and look at the fund. It still has a value, so that wouldn't tell me about this month's payment. I'd need to go into the SIP and its payment entries. Looking at the entries, I'd find an unsuccessful October entry and an earlier unsuccessful September one, with August the last completed payment. That is more of a gap than I thought. November isn't due yet. I would check the bank account linked to the instruction next.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P04: The tenth of November is still shown as the next date here. Before this I would have treated that as proof it was running. Now I'd want to know whether the next attempt is actually able to debit the right account. The date being there doesn't settle that.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P04: The overall value and whether it's up or down. If it moved, I assumed things were happening. I didn't separate a change in the value of the earlier units from a new monthly purchase. That's probably why the missed payments didn't stand out.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P04: It was in Nov 2025, after the first instalment. I remember seeing a small positive return when I checked, though I don't remember the day or the figure. I felt pleased that the money was doing something. It matched what I had expected, so I didn't question it much. Looking back, I was treating one early positive result as reassurance about the whole decision. The flat result in June felt different.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P04: Daily at the start, then a couple of times a month. Less during the job change. Last time I opened it was to look at the return after a conversation with friends. I didn't inspect the individual payments then.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P04: In June I thought about stopping because it looked flat and another person was talking about better returns. I asked the friend who helped me start, and I left it alone. The later missed months weren't that

decision coming back. I didn't decide in September that I no longer wanted to invest. I just didn't deal with the payment issue.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

P04: It happened, rather than a decision to stop. I saw the first failed-payment message, but I didn't understand the whole sequence until checking the entries here. I want to continue. I need to confirm the funding account and what I have to change, then see a new payment actually complete. Saying I'll fix it after work isn't the same as doing that. I haven't done it yet.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P04: I knew cancelling would stop future payments. I hadn't used a temporary option.

Interviewer follow-up: *Had you heard you could skip a month or lower the amount?*

P04: Lowering, yes, but that isn't what I need here. I have the money in the other account. I need to make sure the payment comes from where the money is. Skipping another month wouldn't sort that out.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P04: Yes, it looked flat in June. In June I thought the flat number meant I wasn't getting much benefit. I stayed because I wasn't investing for June itself and the contribution was comfortable. But that decision didn't protect me from missing later payments. Those happened for a different reason.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P04: The last return question went to my friend and then I read a couple of explanations. For the failed payment I haven't properly asked anyone yet. I'd start with the account details and the help for that transaction. I don't want to guess whether to create a new instruction and accidentally end up with two.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P04: No. I saw the notification and kept postponing it. I can't tell you support was difficult because I haven't tried. If checking the linked account doesn't make the next step clear, that's where I'd go.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Not administered — participant already detailed an actual missed-payment episode in Q12–Q13.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P04: Until August, the payment happened automatically and the contribution was manageable. To continue now, I need to finish the bank-account change rather than just intend to. A reminder that there is a SIP on the tenth isn't enough if I still don't know which account it will try.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P04: At the first failed payment, something I could connect to the account I had just stopped using. I don't remember the message well enough to say that information wasn't there. I wasn't paying much attention. But I needed a clear next step and a way to check the change had worked.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P04: If you had asked whether I still had a SIP, I'd have said yes. I meant I hadn't cancelled it. I wasn't thinking of when the last payment actually succeeded.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P04: I could try something, especially if it helps me understand the account setup. I can't promise a slot right now. Send the details first.

Participant 05: P05 (30F, Alliances and Partnerships Manager)

> **Participant Profile:** 30F · Alliances and Partnerships Manager.
>
> **Investment Timeline:** First successful instalment in March; salary-funded. Voluntarily stepped down her monthly contribution starting in July after feeling uneasy about early return fluctuations, without pausing or stopping. Latest completed instalment on 12 October 2026; next scheduled date on 12 November. No payment hiccups.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P05: I had been saving, just not through mutual funds. I sat down with my expenses and realised that money in my account didn't really have a purpose beyond being available. I started in March. I wasn't new to earning, but I was new to choosing a market-linked investment myself. I had put it off because I thought I'd need to understand a lot more before doing anything. I was happy investing in FD’s and gold exclusively before this.

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P05: My brother talked me through how he had made it a monthly habit. HE asked what I wanted the money for rather than starting with a fund name. I also read some beginner material. There wasn't one dramatic moment. I got tired of keeping it on my list of things to learn. And my brother is Gen-Z as they say, these people know more about this stuff so I could trust him.

Q3. Why Groww?

P05: I had heard of Groww and could understand the flow when I tried it. I wanted to manage this myself. I didn't want somebody else having to make every change for me, even though I was asking people questions while starting.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P05: I said long term, perhaps for something substantial a few years away, but I hadn't chosen one fixed goal. I expected some fluctuation. What surprised me was how quickly I began judging it after only a few contributions. I had a rough return number in my head from what I'd read, but I couldn't have explained how that related to my own first few months. I knew it was long term gains, everything from youtube, people, AI, pointed that way. But I couldn’t help myself from looking for green in the portfolio.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P05: From my monthly surplus after regular expenses and savings I wanted to keep accessible. I could afford the original contribution. Later, when I reduced it, it wasn't because a bill had suddenly become impossible. I had discovered that being able to pay and being comfortable seeing that much exposed to movement weren't quite the same feeling.

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P05: The twelfth, comfortably after salary and rent. I didn't want several debits clustered on the same day. The money has been in the account before the SIP date

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P05: My salary. That hasn't changed. I didn't start this with money borrowed or sent by family.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

Not asked — participant's first SIP is not an ELSS tax-saver fund.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P05: March was setup and the first payment. April I was pleased that I had finally started. In May and June the return looked underwhelming to me and I was checking more than I liked. I decided on a smaller contribution before July's payment. July onward, the lower contribution kept going. By October I was checking less. I haven't seen enough to claim I now know how I'll react to every kind of market movement.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P05: 12 March. I saw the debit and later checked the transaction in the app. That was when it felt real. Up to then, approving something on a screen didn't feel the same as having invested.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight away? Have you changed it?

P05: I used the automatic payment setup and it was ready before the first date. I haven't changed the bank. When I reduced the contribution, I checked what the next scheduled payment showed and later checked the actual debit. I don't remember every button, so I wouldn't want to give someone instructions from memory.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P05: No failed or delayed payment that I remember. The only thing I watched carefully was the first debit after changing the contribution, because I wanted to be sure the change had taken effect. It matched what I expected. I didn't incur a charge that I'm aware of.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P05: No episode where I was worried about a debit being missing in Groww. I don't follow the unit count closely enough to say the app updates instantly. I can only say I've not had a problem that made me take action. I know it takes some days to reflect in the MF account anyways.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P05: Nothing that stopped the setup. I did the verification myself. I don't remember an unresolved account issue.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P05: August. I was travelling for work and didn't really look. If a payment failed I would expect an alert, but I wouldn't claim I'd definitely catch it that day. I do still notice the bank debit more reliably than app notifications.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

Verbal app walkthrough (privacy protocol — screen and rupee amounts not shared).

P05: I would go to the SIP and then the payment history. I would check the date and the completed entry, especially the first one after changing the contribution. Right now, November isn't due yet. The October payment is the latest one I'd expect to see. The overall return screen isn't where I'd confirm it.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P05: 12 November. I'd check the next scheduled date in the SIP details. I'd also want the scheduled contribution there to match the lower one, rather than assume the change I made months ago still looks right.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P05: The gain or loss, usually. I tell myself I'll check the contribution history, but my eyes still go to the return. In June I felt annoyed with myself for choosing something I didn't understand well enough. It wasn't that I thought the app had taken a fee whenever it was red. I was questioning my decision.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P05: In March, I compared what I'd paid in with the current value. There wasn't much difference. That seemed reasonable for a new investment, and I was mainly pleased I'd finally started. I expected the difference to become more noticeable after a few contributions. By May and June I was looking more often and feeling disappointed. My expectation had become much more immediate than the long-term plan I had described to myself.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P05: It became almost daily in May and June. Now a couple of times a month. The last time was after the October debit, partly to confirm it and partly to see the return. Reducing the contribution made me less tempted to keep checking, but I can't say that would happen for everybody.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P05: Yes, I reduced it. I initially thought the choice was to keep paying the same contribution or stop. I talked my brother who had helped me start, and then looked through what I could change. I chose a smaller recurring contribution. I didn't redeem the earlier investment. I wanted to keep the habit while giving myself time to understand what I was comfortable with. There wasn't an urgent expense behind it. I lowered the amount because of the slow market, I reinvested the difference back into my FD’s

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

Not asked — contribution amount was reduced, with no pause, stop, or lapse.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P05: Now I know I can change what I contribute, because I've done it. At the start I mainly knew about cancelling.

Interviewer follow-up: *What about skipping a month?*

P05: I've heard of it but haven't needed it. My discomfort wasn't limited to one particular month, so a one-month break didn't seem to address it. I wanted an ongoing contribution I could live with.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P05: Yes, it looked flat in May and June. I thought flat meant the decision wasn't working, even though I knew the investment wasn't supposed to give a fixed monthly result. Seeing it on my own money made it harder than reading about it. I stayed with a lower contribution. I wasn't convinced the next month would be better; I just felt more comfortable continuing that way.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P05: My brother, then some reading about how to judge early SIP performance. I also looked at the app to see what changing the contribution would actually do. The conversation didn't end with her telling me which fund to buy. It ended with me deciding how much I was comfortable committing for now.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P05: No. I could make the change I wanted and then verify the next payment. I might contact support if the scheduled payment looked wrong. I wouldn't necessarily ask support whether my discomfort with the investment was reasonable.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Scenario Card 1: It's two days after your SIP date. You get a message saying your SIP instalment could not be processed. Groww shows it as failed.

Interviewer: *What would you do next? Where would you look first, who would you ask, and what would you do with the SIP?*

P05: I'd look for the reason against that particular payment and check the bank balance and debit history. If I still couldn't tell what failed, I'd contact support. I wouldn't immediately cancel the instruction. I'd want to know whether it will be attempted again before I try paying manually. That would decide my next step; I don't know the answer now.

Note: Prospective response to a hypothetical scenario card, rather than a past payment incident.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P05: The smaller contribution is easier for me to leave alone. The money is still being set aside without a monthly decision. I don't have to prove that I can tolerate a bigger commitment just because I originally entered it. That has made continuing feel more practical.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P05: At the point I was considering stopping, I wanted to understand what would happen to the existing investment and what would change for the next payment. I didn't want to accidentally sell anything. Clear consequences would have been useful before I made the change, rather than reassurance about future returns.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P05: A reduced SIP can be a deliberate choice, not a sign that I've given up on investing. I might increase it later, but I don't have a date for that and I don't want to treat that as a promise.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P05: Yes, if I can try it at a time that works with my schedule. I'd be interested in something I can understand without a person walking me through it.

Participant 06: P06 (28M, Product Manager)

> **Participant Profile:** 28M · Product Manager.
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> **Investment Timeline:** First successful instalment on 5 June 2026; salary-funded. Four monthly payments completed through 5 September. Cancelled future instalments on 15 September because the early result seemed disappointing compared with fund history and peers. No October payment, replacement SIP or restart as of 4 November 2026. Existing units remain invested; no payment failures.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P06: I had been meaning to organise my savings instead of leaving surplus money in the account. In May I finally set up a SIP, with June as the first payment. This was my first mutual fund. I wanted a regular investment habit, but I also wanted to feel I had picked a good fund. I hadn't thought much about how quickly I would start evaluating that choice.

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P06: Well. I was already a finance grad through college. So I know a lot about investing options. I initially went all in on stocks, but over time, with the current market issues, decided to try out a MF SIP

Q3. Why Groww?

P06: It was familiar, people I knew used it, I already used it for stocks and I could get through the setup myself. I liked having the fund information and my investment together. I didn't choose Groww because I expected the platform to guarantee the return, although later I did keep going back to those historical figures.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P06: I said years, but privately I expected to see evidence within a few months that I had made a good selection. I had the fund's past annualised return in mind and compared my progress with that. I knew the figures weren't a promise. Even so, a flat-looking result after several payments felt like a bad choice rather than just a short period. I went risky with more small and mid cap funds instead of large cap.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P06: A portion of my monthly surplus after bills and emergency savings. It was affordable when I started and still affordable when I cancelled. There wasn't a sudden expense or salary cut. I stopped because I wasn't convinced about where the money was going, not because I couldn't spare it. I am a risky trader, so wanted to try that instead of keeping it in a down market MF.

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P06: The fifth, just after salary. I wanted the investment done before the month's discretionary spending. All four payments went through on that schedule. I didn't change the date before cancelling.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P06: My salary, from the same bank account throughout. Since stopping, I've kept that monthly surplus in the bank while comparing options. I haven't actually moved it into another SIP or started investing through another platform. Reading about alternatives has taken much longer than I expected.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

P06: It wasn't an ELSS fund. I wasn't using the first SIP for tax saving, so ELSS rules weren't part of why I started or stopped.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P06: June was the first payment and I checked that it had worked. In July I began comparing my return with figures friends mentioned. In August I kept looking at ratings, the fund's past chart and other funds. September's payment completed on the fifth. On the fifteenth I cancelled future payments, thinking I'd choose something better before October. I didn't complete another setup. October passed without a contribution, and there is still no new SIP in early November. I kept the original units. I am keeping an eye on the market fpr opportunities, maybe I will start another SIP, large cap this time, with less funds

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P06: 5 June 2026. The bank debit came first, then the completed investment entry. I checked both. The confirmation when I created the SIP hadn't, by itself, meant that money had been invested.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight away? Have you changed it?

P06: I approved automatic payments during the initial setup. I don't remember an approval issue, and the June payment completed. I kept the same bank and amount until cancelling in September. I checked that the old instruction had stopped. I looked at other funds afterwards, but I didn't authorise a replacement instruction.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P06: No. June, July, August and September all completed. I checked the account in October because I wanted to make sure I hadn't left the original running. There was no debit. That was the cancellation working, not a failed instalment. I haven't noticed a cancellation charge or had a failed payment to recover.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P06: I haven't had a worrying missing-money incident. I saw payments processing before completion, but nothing I needed to chase. The concern that made me stop was the return on the money already invested, not uncertainty over whether the purchases had completed. I know the delays with trading and how they work, so never really worried.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P06: No issue that stopped the setup. The account and early payments worked. I didn't have a KYC problem when I cancelled either. Choosing what I wanted to invest in was the part I found difficult.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P06: While it ran, I was checking too often to forget it for a whole month. After cancelling, there were weeks when I only thought about it when someone mentioned returns. If an active instalment failed, I'd expect a message and would check the transaction. I haven't experienced that failure, so I can't say how quickly I'd act during a busy week.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

Verbal app walkthrough (privacy protocol — screen and rupee amounts not shared).

P06: I'd find the original SIP and check its status and transaction history. September should be the last completed payment. There shouldn't be an October contribution or a new active instruction. I can still open the holding, but its value moving doesn't mean I'm investing monthly. If I only looked at the portfolio total, I'd miss that distinction.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P06: There isn't one. The fifth was my old date, but I don't have a payment scheduled for 5 November. I'd check the cancelled SIP and the active SIP list to confirm that. I've shortlisted alternatives; I haven't set one up.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P06: My return, then the fund's historical numbers or another fund's chart. That is the loop I got into. A friend's higher percentage made mine feel poor without my checking when he invested or what risk he was taking. I understand that comparison is weak, but seeing the difference still bothers me.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P06: In June I remember a small green figure after the first payment. I took it as reassurance that I had selected well. I hadn't earned enough from it to draw any conclusion. By July and August, when the result wasn't as encouraging, I was already treating those early numbers as a verdict on the fund. I expected a quicker answer than a few months could reasonably give me.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P06: Several times a week while deciding whether to stop. Less now, maybe every couple of weeks, though I still browse fund comparisons outside Groww. Last time was in late October to look at the old holding. I didn't create a new SIP. I keep thinking I should finish the research first.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P06: I cancelled on 15 September, after four successful payments. I was disappointed with the early result and kept seeing alternatives that looked better. A friend told me to compare the same periods, but I was already doubtful about the choice. I stopped future payments and planned to pick another fund. I didn't sell the earlier units. The replacement stayed a plan, so I ended up stopping all SIP contributions.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

P06: The cancellation was deliberate. The length of the gap wasn't planned. I thought I'd sort out a better choice within a couple of weeks, but every comparison gave me another option. I checked the cancelled status and the absence of the October debit. Restarting would mean settling on a fund and a contribution, setting it up and seeing a payment complete. I haven't done that yet.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P06: I knew about lowering the amount and had heard of a temporary pause. I didn't investigate whether a pause was available for that particular SIP. My concern was the fund selection, so I went straight to stopping future contributions.

Interviewer follow-up: *Did you know about skipping a month or lowering the amount before the change?*

P06: Lowering, yes. Skipping, only vaguely. A lower amount would have left me with the same question about the fund, and I didn't think one month would be enough to answer it. Looking back, cancelling before I had decided what to do next made it easy for the research to become a long gap.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P06: Yes, it looked almost flat to me in August. I took that as a sign that my choice wasn't earning enough, particularly when friends talked about better results. I didn't properly match the time periods. I let September's payment happen, then stopped. I'm describing why I lost confidence, not proving that the fund was underperforming. The money for the contribution was still available.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P06: A friend, fund-information pages and YouTube comparisons. I also used AI to explain why my SIP return could differ from a fund's historical figure, then checked the explanation against what I'd read. Before cancelling I looked up what would happen to the existing units. I got the mechanics clear, but I still didn't have a firm rule for choosing the next fund.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P06: No. I used the help content to understand cancellation and then checked the status. I didn't think a support ticket would settle whether I had picked the right fund. There wasn't a payment missing that I needed them to trace.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Scenario Card 2: Your bank shows the SIP money has gone. Two days later Groww still shows processing and no new units.

Interviewer: *What would you do next? Where would you look first, who would you ask, and what would you do with the SIP?*

P06: Assuming I still had an active SIP, I'd open the order details, match the bank debit and look for the stated processing window. If it remained unclear, I'd contact support about that transaction. I wouldn't pay again just because units weren't visible yet. Right now I have no active instruction, so any new debit would first make me check which order caused it and whether the cancellation had taken effect.

Note: Hypothetical response assuming an active SIP; no actual missing-money episode or replacement SIP is part of this revised case.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P06: A better way to judge progress would probably have helped. I could afford the payment and wanted to invest, but I kept using a few months of returns to question the whole choice. I needed to understand which

comparisons were meaningful and how often to review them. To restart now, I need to stop postponing the decision until I find something that looks certain.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P06: In August and September I had plenty of information but no clear way to use it. Understanding the difference between my own return and a fund's longer history would have helped before I cancelled. I don't think another list of top funds would have solved it. That was already what I kept searching for.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P06: I can still have money invested and have stopped the monthly habit. If you asked whether I hold mutual funds, I'd say yes. If you asked when I last contributed, it was September. I haven't switched successfully just because I looked at other funds.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P06: Yes, depending on timing. I'd be interested in trying something that helps me interpret my own history. I wouldn't want it to assume I've already chosen a new fund or committed to restarting.

Participant 07: P07 (27F, MBA Student)

> **Participant Profile:** 27F · MBA Student.
>
> **Investment Timeline:** First completed instalment on 17 June 2026, funded from an MBA summer internship stipend. Three payments completed through 17 August, with the final payment funded from stipend savings. Cancelled on 25 August before the September instalment because the stipend had ended and remaining cash was needed for living and academic expenses. No restart or replacement SIP as of 4 November 2026. Existing units retained; no payment failures.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P07: I was doing a paid summer internship during my MBA. I got the first stipend in May and felt I should save something from money I had earned. I set up the SIP for June. Friends had already started investing before the MBA, so I wanted to begin too. I knew the internship was temporary, but I hadn't planned the SIP beyond the months when money was coming in. IT was basically just trying to get into good habits before I start my job next year

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P07: A friend from my batch explained what a monthly SIP involved. I also saw videos about starting early, even with a small amount. It felt better than spending the whole stipend. I focused on being able to make the first few payments and didn't properly ask what would fund it once classes resumed and the internship was over.

Q3. Why Groww?

P07: Friends used Groww and I could ask them if I got confused. The setup looked manageable on my phone. I wanted to do it myself. I didn't make a detailed comparison with other platforms or think much about what stopping would involve.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P07: I wanted it to stay invested for years, ideally until I was earning full time and could add more. I hoped it would grow, although I hadn't set a return target. I wasn't planning to use it for the next semester's fees. The mistake was assuming I could keep making monthly contributions from a stipend that was only going to last a short time.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P07: From what was left after my expenses during an internship month. I picked a small amount that felt easy then. I didn't write out the budget for the months after the internship. Travel for placements, course expenses and normal living costs were all going to come from the same savings later.

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P07: The seventeenth, because the stipend had arrived before that. It worked for June and July. August's payment came from what I had saved from the stipend. After that, moving the date wouldn't have fixed anything because there was no new monthly income.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P07: My own internship stipend and then savings from it. The regular stipend stopped after July. I wasn't earning a full-time salary, and the money I had left also had to cover student expenses. I didn't want to ask my family to send extra money just so I could keep an SIP going.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

P07: My first SIP wasn't in an ELSS fund. I wasn't earning enough from the internship for tax saving to be the reason I started it. I didn't choose a tax-saver fund or rely on an ELSS deduction.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P07: June was the first payment. July went through while I still had stipend income. I saw a red figure that month, asked a friend about it and continued. The internship ended in July. August's payment came from the stipend money I had saved. Before September I wrote down the expenses coming up and realised the savings had to last. I cancelled on 25 August after three completed payments. There were no payments in September or October, and I haven't restarted in early November.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P07: 17 June 2026. I saw the bank debit and later the investment in Groww. I was quite pleased because I had actually started instead of only talking about it. I checked with my friend that the investment entry meant the purchase had completed.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight away? Have you changed it?

P07: I approved the recurring payment during setup, and it was ready for June. I used the same bank account throughout. On 25 August I cancelled future instalments. I checked the status and that there wasn't another upcoming payment. I didn't sell the units already bought.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P07: No failed instalment. June, July and August all completed. September wasn't an attempt that bounced; I had cancelled before it was due. I didn't notice a payment-failure or cancellation charge. I stopped before the lack of income became a debit problem.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P07: I remember checking after the first debit, but I can't recall the exact time until the investment appeared. I haven't had a delay that made me think the money was missing or contact support. That wasn't connected to why I stopped.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P07: Nothing that stopped me starting. I completed the verification and could make the June payment. I don't remember the individual screens well enough to describe them. There wasn't a pending account issue when I cancelled.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P07: October. Once I had cancelled, classes and placement preparation took over and I wasn't thinking about the SIP much. While it was active, I mostly noticed the bank message and checked the investment after that. I hadn't set up a separate reminder to catch a failed payment.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

Verbal app walkthrough (privacy protocol — screen and rupee amounts not shared).

P07: I'd open the SIP details and check that the instruction is cancelled, then look at the old transactions. August should be the last completed payment. There shouldn't be a September or October contribution, and I haven't authorised one for November. The existing units are still there, but that isn't evidence of a current monthly SIP.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P07: There isn't a next instalment. I'd check the cancelled instruction and upcoming payments to make sure. I hope to start again after getting a full-time job, but I don't have a confirmed payment date or a new SIP set up.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P07: The current value and whether it is above or below what I put in. Red still feels disappointing. Lately I think more about the cash left in my bank account and how long it needs to last. Even if the investment looked better, it wouldn't give me a new stipend to fund another monthly payment.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P07: After the June payment, the value looked close to the amount I had invested. I was mainly happy that I could see it. I expected some growth over time but hadn't thought much about an early loss. Seeing red in July was uncomfortable. I asked about it and still made August's contribution. The budget problem became clear after that.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P07: Several times a week at the start. Much less after August. I last opened it sometime in October to see the units I had kept. I didn't set up a new payment. Right now the placement process gets much more of my attention.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P07: I stopped on 25 August, before September's payment. The stipend had ended and I needed the remaining savings for living costs, academic expenses and placement travel. I spoke to a friend, wrote out the budget and cancelled future instalments. I had worried about returns in July, but I hadn't stopped then. Even with a positive return, I would still have needed to stop once there was no regular income.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

P07: It was a decision. I didn't wait for a payment to fail. I checked that the SIP was cancelled and later that no September debit happened. To restart, I'd want a job and a realistic idea of what is left after expenses and any education-loan payments. I haven't received a full-time salary or set up another instruction yet.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P07: I'd heard about reducing the amount and taking a temporary break. I hadn't used either. I checked enough to know that cancelling future payments would let me keep the existing investment.

Interviewer follow-up: *What about skipping a month or lowering it instead?*

P07: A smaller amount could have stretched the savings a little further, but it would still come out of money I might need for the course. I didn't know how many months it would be before I earned again, so skipping one month didn't solve the planning problem. I preferred to stop and decide afresh when I had income.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P07: Yes, red in July. I thought maybe I had picked a bad time to start. A friend explained that a few weeks didn't tell me much, and I continued in August. I stopped later because the stipend had ended. I don't want the early worry about returns to get treated as the reason for the cancellation. The same cash limit would have existed if it had been green.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P07: My friend from the MBA, then my own expense list. I also read the cancellation help to check what would happen to the money already invested. I wasn't searching for a better fund at that point. I needed to know whether I could afford any regular contribution after the internship, and the answer was no for now.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P07: No. I could complete the cancellation and check the status using the information available. I haven't had a payment I needed them to trace, so I can't describe a support experience. If an unexpected debit happened now, I would contact them with the cancellation details.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Scenario Card 1: It's two days after your SIP date. You get a message saying your SIP instalment could not be processed. Groww shows it as failed.

Interviewer: *What would you do next? Where would you look first, who would you ask, and what would you do with the SIP?*

P07: If this happened while the SIP was active, I'd check the bank balance and the failure reason first. If I had the money and it looked like a setup issue, I'd use the help for that transaction or contact support. If I couldn't afford it, I wouldn't keep retrying without reviewing the budget. With my SIP cancelled now, an attempted payment would make me check the cancellation status immediately.

Note: Hypothetical response assuming an active SIP; no actual failed payment occurred in the revised case.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P07: Reliable income would have made the difference. The small amount worked during the internship, but it still needed a source after the internship ended. Planning that before I started might have led me to choose a different approach for the stipend. Reminders or a better-looking return wouldn't have paid the

next instalment. Anyways, as I said, this was just an attempt to get into good investing habits before starting my full time job

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P07: I wish I had budgeted for the whole academic term before committing to monthly payments. At cancellation, I mainly wanted confidence that I could stop the debits and leave the existing units alone. I didn't need someone telling me to find extra money. I needed the cash I already had to last.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P07: A stipend and a salary can look similar for a couple of months, but they aren't the same basis for an ongoing commitment. I still want to invest after I start working. I just haven't reached the point where I can say what amount will be sustainable.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P07: Possibly, around classes and placements. I can try an exercise and give feedback. I wouldn't want it to require a real payment or assume I can restart this week.

Participant 08: P08 (26M, IT Engineer)

> **Participant Profile:** 26M · IT Engineer.
>
> **Investment Timeline:** First successful instalment on 9 February 2026; salary-funded. Five monthly payments completed through 9 June. Following a family medical emergency in mid-June, cancelled future instalments on 20 June before the July payment. Partially redeemed existing units in July for uncovered costs; remaining units retained. Ongoing family expenses and rebuilding cash savings have prevented a restart. No payments from July onward and no replacement SIP as of 4 November 2026; no payment failures.

1 WHY THEY STARTED AND WHAT THEY EXPECTED

Q1. Take me back to when you set up your first SIP. What was going on in your life then?

P08: I was earning regularly and wanted to stop spending whatever was left at the end of the month. A friend had been suggesting a SIP. I set it up in January, and the first payment was in February. I thought I had enough set aside for normal surprises. I hadn't really tested what would happen if there was a bigger family expense.

Q2. Who or what got you to start?

P08: A friend who had been investing for a while. I watched a few beginner videos too. The idea of making one decision and letting it happen monthly appealed to me. I wanted to save for later rather than keep finding uses for the spare money. Nobody in the family was depending on that contribution at the time.

Q3. Why Groww?

P08: Friends used Groww and I could follow the setup without much help. I wanted to manage it from my phone. I didn't compare the payment features of different apps. The app was familiar enough for me to get started.

Q4. What did you expect would happen to the money, and by when?

P08: I expected it to build over several years. I didn't have one exact purchase attached to it. I knew the value could go down, though naturally I hoped to see a gain. I wasn't expecting the SIP to fund a hospital bill within months. The family expense changed what I needed the money for.

Q5. How did you decide the amount?

P08: From what was left after rent, bills, money sent home and some cash savings. It looked affordable, and it was until June. When my father's treatment costs came up, more of my salary had to go home. The old SIP amount no longer felt like spare money, even though my salary itself hadn't changed.

Q6. How did you pick the date?

P08: The ninth, after salary. The timing worked for all five payments. When the medical expense came up, changing the date wouldn't have helped. I needed to keep the money available rather than move the debit a few days.

Q7. Where does the money for the SIP come from? Has that ever changed?

P08: My salary from the same account throughout. Since June, I've been sending more home for treatment and related expenses. I also need to rebuild the cash savings we used. There wasn't a job loss or bank-account change. There just wasn't the same surplus left for investing.

Q8. Only if the first SIP was an ELSS: What did you know about ELSS when you started?

P08: It wasn't an ELSS fund. I wasn't starting it for tax saving. That mattered later because I wasn't dealing with an ELSS lock-in when I needed to look at withdrawing part of the holding.

2 WHAT THE EXPERIENCE HAS BEEN SINCE

Q9. Let's go month by month, from the start to now. What happened first?

P08: February was the first payment. March and April were routine, and I checked the value now and then. May and the 9 June payment also went through. My father needed hospital treatment in mid-June. Insurance didn't cover everything, and the family had to arrange cash. I cancelled the SIP on 20 June before the July date. In July I also withdrew part of the existing holding for the uncovered costs. August through October went into treatment expenses and rebuilding cash savings. I haven't restarted in November.

Q10. When did the first instalment actually go out? How did you know?

P08: 9 February 2026. I saw the bank debit and then the investment entry. It went through when I expected. June was the fifth and last payment. I haven't had another successful SIP instalment since then.

Q11. How did you set up the monthly payment? Was it approved straight away? Have you changed it?

P08: I approved automatic payments during the original setup, and it was ready for February. I didn't change the bank or amount. On 20 June I cancelled future SIP payments and checked the status. The partial withdrawal in July was a separate request. I haven't created a new SIP instruction since cancelling.

Q12. Has an instalment ever not gone through, been late, or looked confusing? What happened, what did you do, and did it cost you anything?

P08: No failed instalment. February through June all completed. July had no attempt because I had cancelled in advance. I didn't notice a charge for stopping the SIP. The later partial withdrawal was a separate transaction, and I'd need to check its statement to tell you exactly what deductions applied. I wouldn't mix that up with a failed-payment fee.

Q13. Has money ever left your bank but not shown up in Groww straight away?

P08: I've seen a processing stage after a debit, but not an incident where the SIP money was missing and I had to chase it. In July I was checking money coming back from a withdrawal, which is different from a new SIP purchase. The cancellation wasn't caused by a processing delay.

Q14. Was there any KYC or account problem around the start?

P08: No KYC or account issue that held up the start. The early payments worked. I could also access the account when I cancelled and later requested the partial withdrawal. The difficult part was arranging the family money, not getting into the app.

Q15. Was there a month when you didn't think about the SIP at all? If an instalment failed, how would you find out?

P08: March was fairly automatic; I wasn't opening it all the time. In August, after cancelling, I barely thought about investments because of things at home. While it was active, a bank message was how I usually knew a payment happened. I'd need to check the transaction history if one failed. That didn't happen in my five payments.

3 WHAT THEY CHECK AND HOW IT FEELS

Q16. Can you open Groww now and describe the taps, without sharing your screen or amounts? How would you check whether this month's instalment went through?

Verbal app walkthrough (privacy protocol — screen and rupee amounts not shared).

P08: I'd find the cancelled SIP and open the transaction history. June should be the last contribution. I'd also see the separate July withdrawal, and the units left after that. There shouldn't be an October or November instalment from this instruction. A remaining portfolio value only means I still hold some units; it doesn't mean a monthly debit is running.

Q17. When is your next instalment? Where would you find that?

P08: There isn't a next instalment. The ninth was the old date, but I don't have a payment scheduled for 9 November. I'd verify the cancelled status and upcoming payments. I've talked about starting again, but I haven't picked a date or authorised a new payment.

Q18. When you open the app normally, what's the first thing you look at? What do you feel, and what does that number tell you?

P08: The amount still invested, then the gain or loss. After the hospital expense, I also think about what cash we have available outside the fund. I don't feel good about breaking the habit, but keeping money ready for the family feels more urgent. A green figure alone wouldn't change the monthly budget.

Q18a. Think back to the first time you looked at how your SIP was doing. What did you see, and what did you think? Was that what you expected by then?

P08: After the first February payment, the value was close to what I'd put in. I was pleased that I had started. I expected growth over the years, without a fixed monthly result. Later I saw flat or red figures on some checks, which wasn't enjoyable, but I still made the next payments. The medical expense was what changed the plan.

Q19. How often do you open it? When did you last, and why?

P08: Once or twice a week at the beginning, then less. I checked more around the July withdrawal because I needed the money. Since then maybe once a month. I last opened it in late October to look at the remaining holding. I didn't restart the SIP.

4 PAUSING REDUCING OR THINKING ABOUT STOPPING

Q20. Have you ever paused, skipped, reduced or thought about stopping? What was happening, who did you talk to, and what did you do?

P08: I cancelled on 20 June after my father's hospital treatment started. Some costs weren't covered, and we had more expenses coming up. I discussed the budget with my family, stopped future SIP payments and later withdrew part of the existing investment in July. I left the rest invested. I hoped it would be a short break, but treatment costs and rebuilding the cash buffer have kept the SIP off since then.

Q21. If you stopped or it lapsed: Was it a decision, or did it just happen? How did you find out, and what would restarting take?

P08: It was deliberate. I didn't wait for the account to run short on the SIP date. I checked the cancellation and that no July debit happened. Restarting would need the ongoing family costs to settle and enough cash savings that another bill wouldn't force me straight back out. I haven't reached that point or made a new SIP payment.

Q22. Apart from cancelling, what options do you know of for a month when you can't or don't want to pay?

P08: I knew cancellation was available. I'd heard that some SIPs could be paused or reduced, but I hadn't checked the rules for mine before the emergency. I mainly wanted to stop the next commitment and keep the money accessible.

Interviewer follow-up: *Had you heard about skipping a month or lowering the amount?*

P08: I'd heard of both, but I didn't know how long the extra expenses would last. A skipped month would have meant another date to watch. Even a lower contribution was money we might need at home. I might consider a smaller SIP when the budget settles, but I haven't set one up.

Q23. Has the number ever been red or flat? What did you think it meant? What did you do, or think about doing? What made you stay, or not?

P08: Yes, on some checks before June. It made me a little uneasy, but it didn't make me cancel. The five payments still happened. I stopped when we needed cash for treatment and had continuing expenses to cover. I would have needed that money even if the return had looked good. The partial withdrawal was for the bill, not an attempt to time a market fall.

5 WHAT THEY DO OUTSIDE THE APP

Q24. Think of the last time you weren't sure about your SIP. Who or what did you turn to, and what did you do next?

P08: My family first, because we needed to work out what had to be paid and what was covered. Then I asked the friend who helped me start about cancelling versus withdrawing. I checked the app's information before doing each. I wasn't looking for a fund with better returns at that point. I was trying to work out which money was available and when.

Q25. Have you ever contacted Groww support? What happened, did it get sorted, and how did that feel?

P08: No. I found the information I needed for the cancellation and partial withdrawal, and I didn't have an unresolved transaction to chase. I checked the status myself. If the money from the withdrawal hadn't arrived within the stated timeframe, I would have contacted support, but that isn't something I had to do.

6 PAYMENT SCENARIO

Scenario Card 2: Your bank shows the SIP money has gone. Two days later Groww still shows processing and no new units.

Interviewer: *What would you do next? Where would you look first, who would you ask, and what would you do with the SIP?*

P08: If I imagine an active SIP, I'd check that order against the bank debit and read the processing information. If I still couldn't understand the status, I'd ask support before paying again. When cash is tight I would want that clarified quickly. With my current SIP cancelled, I'd first ask where an unexpected new debit came from and check the cancellation confirmation. I wouldn't create another SIP to fix a pending purchase.

Note: Hypothetical response assuming an active SIP; the revised case has no actual missing-money incident and no October restart.

7 WHAT WOULD HELP THEM CONTINUE

Q26. What has kept your SIP going so far, or what would have?

P08: A bigger cash buffer and less uncertainty about the ongoing family costs would have made continuing possible. The automatic payment worked, and I still want to invest. Right now I need to know I can leave the

contribution alone without needing it for the next bill. A reminder by itself wouldn't make that money available.

Q27. Think of the hardest moment you described. What would have made it easier?

P08: During the hospital period I needed a simple explanation of what stopping the SIP would do and what withdrawing units would do, including how long the withdrawal might take and any costs. I had very little attention for learning a new process. It also would have helped to have planned a larger emergency buffer before committing so much of the surplus.

8 CLOSE

Q28. Is there anything about your SIP I didn't ask that I should have?

P08: My salary didn't fall, but the amount I could spare changed a lot. You could look at the same job and think I should still be able to pay. The family commitments are what changed. I still have some units, but I haven't made a monthly contribution since June.

Q29. Later this week there may be something small to try, about 20 minutes. Would you be open to that?

P08: I can try something after work if things at home allow. I'd prefer an exercise that doesn't require a real transaction. I wouldn't want it to treat trying the exercise as a promise to restart.